Project Report:

Name:	Tanmay Sondhiya
Reg.no:	25BCE10238
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Introduction:

This project aims to help students with the basic knowledge about Digital Literacy and help them realise its importance in this modern digital era. Its ultimate goal is to help peers navigate the digital world safely and professionally.

It aims to do this via various methods like using presentations, worst-case scenarios, the risks, prevention checklists, do's and don'ts checklist, self-learning platforms, establishing a professional presence on platforms like LinkedIn, GitHub as well as making the students aware about the professional way of drafting emails.

This report summarizes the 5 tasks completed to achieve the goal of this project and to demonstrate digital literacy. It contains the thought processes involved while making this project, the tools used as well as the learnings made after completing it.

Task-1

Used Prezi for my presentation as I thought that the animation on it looked very seamless and can catch the attention of the audience. It is has a variety of free templates which can be used as such or can even be tinkered with to modify it as per as the user's needs.

The design of my presentation shows how simple design but catchy animation can look clean and feel good while watching it. The design can even be changed if wanted.

The one thing I found difficult while making my presentation was just the choice of templated. There are a decent amount of templated but not all of them go well with any topic. So a bigger free library could be a way to make prezi more mainstream like power point.

One thing I found interesting was how even inside templates individual animations and objects can be added. Moreover I found the whole idea of it being a all part of a big canvas and the camera just zooms and pans around it very interesting.

Task-2

I chose three platforms. They were LinkedIn, Kaggle and ReseachGate.

LinkedIn is used for maintaining your professional profile so that people can see your skills and send you job offers if they find your skills apt for the job.

Kaggle is a website which acts like a community for the data scientists and machine learning practitioners. It is the world largest site for this purpose. It also has numerous tutorials for the people who want to get into this exciting field of engineering.

ReseachGate is a website for people who are interested in sheer learning. People interested in research or researcher's themselves post their research papers online on this website and make them available for all. This way knowledge is accessible for people around the world. It is a mine of knowledge which can help budding researchers a lot during their initial phase.

I plan on using all three of the websites mentioned above to make sure that I keep learning new things and stay active on LinkedIn to update my profile and to make sure that I do not fall behind my peers.

Task-3

I used the Hacker-Rank Website to practise my problem solving and python basics. This website has a variety of problems available for all types of programming topics as well as different languages. I solved a variety of problems on different topics like arrays, lists, strings, tuples and dictionaries. I even solved some comparison problems where you compare the individual elements of multiple arrays and print different things based on different conditions.

I believe that these tools are vital for the development of a student throughout the 4 years on university especially for students majoring in computer science. I hope that I stay consistent at this and keep practising as I believe that the people who are the most successful are not the ones with the most talent but rather the ones who put in the most work and practise diligently. This site even has harder problems as you progress in your ability to make sure that the learning process never stops.

Task-4

A good example of when poor digital communication caused a real-life problem is the 1992 Mars Climate Orbiter incident. One team working on the thruster's data of the orbiter was using English units(pound-seconds) while the team at NASA was expecting the data to be in Newtons. Due to this mishap in digital communication about the units of the calculations due to lack of unit of measure documentation the orbiter went too close to the gravitational field of mars and crashed causing a loss of nearly 340 million dollars.

This could have been avoided by just using a simple script to catch the values which were outside the expected range to recognize if the data was not in the expected unit and to then convert it to the expected one.

Good digital communication could have also helped to prevent this. A simple question was all that was needed.

This is the perfect example of why technical documentation is as important as the code or the calculations.

Task-5

While researching cybercrime in India, I was most surprised by the scale of "Social Engineering" attacks, specifically those targeting UPI users. I has thought that hackers relied on complex coding bugs, however, I learned that most financial losses occur because attackers simply exploit human psychology using urgency or fear to trick people into giving away their PINs or OTPs. Seeing that even tech-savvy college students are frequently targeted by fake "Scholarship" or "Internship" links was a wake-up call regarding how sophisticated these scams have become.

As a result of this research, I am personally changing my habit of using the same password across multiple platforms. I realized that if one minor site is breached, my entire digital identity is at risk. I have started using a dedicated password manager to ensure every account has a unique, complex password, and I have finally enabled 2FA on my primary Gmail account.

Conclusion:

This whole project helped me realise the importance of digital literacy and the various risks involved in this digital age. It is no longer a technical skill but a must have fundamental survival tool. From the cybercrime research it is proved that the human element and psyche remains the most important link in this digital age.

Ultimately, being "digitally literate" means more than just knowing how to use a device; it involves maintaining a mindset of constant vigilance. By adopting safer digital habits and knowing the correct reporting channels, like the National Cyber Crime Portal (**1930**), we can protect our personal data and contribute to a more secure digital ecosystem for everyone.